

Rionorês: Linguistic Analysis, Dictionary & Grammar

From the Study "Dialecto Rionorês: Contributo para o seu estudo" by Dina Rodrigues Macias (2003) and the Narrative "História de um Louco Criminoso" (collected by Jorge Dias)

1. Introduction: Rio de Onor and Its Dialect

Rio de Onor is a twin village straddling the Portuguese–Spanish border in the Bragança district of northeastern Portugal. The Portuguese half is called *Rihonor de Abajo* and the Spanish half *Rihonor de Arriba*, separated by approximately 150 meters and the river Contensa. The inhabitants call their settlement *al lugar*.

Rionorês is a Leonese dialect — a linguistic island (*ilha linguística*) wedged between Portuguese and Castilian. Like Guadramilês (spoken in nearby Guadramil) and Mirandese (spoken in Terra de Miranda), it is a surviving fragment of the Asturleonese language family that was established in this region when the territory belonged to the Diocese of Astorga (confirmed as late as 1103 by Pope Paschal II).

The dialect survived thanks to the communitarian social structure (*aldeia comunitária*) of Rio de Onor, where collective governance (*al conselho*), communal property, shared milling, and collective herding created intense social cohesion. However, since World War I, compulsory schooling, military service, emigration, and modern communications have eroded the dialect. By the time of Macias's study (2003), Rionorês was described as a "ritual language" — an esoteric relic spoken primarily by the oldest generation "when alone" (*quando solos*), who felt embarrassed to use it before outsiders.

The Rionorês speaker is typically plurilingual, commanding Rionorês, Portuguese, and Spanish with equal facility, switching codes depending on the interlocutor.

Relationship to Guadramilês

Rionorês and Guadramilês are traditionally grouped together as the two "transition dialects" of Asturleonese in Portugal, alongside the more robust Mirandese. Key differences:

- Rio de Onor sits directly on the border (half in Spain), giving Rionorês **stronger Castilian influence** than Guadramilês.
 - Guadramil is deeper inside Portuguese territory, giving Guadramilês **stronger Portuguese influence**.
 - Both share core Leonese features (betacism, diphthongization, 3pl in -n, *nun* negation, *pan* for bread), but Rionorês preserves more archaic Leonese morphology (fuller verb paradigms, the article *al*).
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2. Source Text: "História de um Louco Criminoso"

The primary text is a folk narrative collected by the ethnographer Jorge Dias during his fieldwork in Rio de Onor, published in *Rio de Onor – Comunitarismo Agro-Pastoril* (1984, p. 303). It tells the story of Miguel, an orphan driven mad by beatings, who murders his abusive uncle on the feast of May 3rd.

2.1 Full Text in Rionorês

Un tal Miguel ficou de piquenu sin pai e a mai, marota, terminou-se di cassar cun al Tiu Domingo Tano. I iêl iera mau i batia-le al rapace i bateu-le na cabeça. Que iêl de piquenu iera listu i cun as porradas que le dou na cabeça pusú-se tonto. I aspois tinha outro irmau qui le tchamaban Ougénio, cassou-se cua fia dal tiu Baltazar, a tia Clementina. I despois al tiu Baltazar era mal criou i al tal Miguel nou le deixaba comer, que nun nu podia ber. I un dia, al dia 3 de Maio, fonun à missa i iera al dia de benecir al pan. I al tal tiu Baltazar amanhóu al pindón i dixu: "Rapaces" iou bou hasta cassa inquantu bos bades a benecir al pan". I bienu introu para cassa. I aquíêl iê al dia de comer las magras, i el dixu al Miguel: — "Tu bê-las mas nun nas comes", i nun staba ua alma no lugar. Al Miguel tontu enfadou-se i agarrou-u pelas piernas al arrastru pela canada i iêl iba boca abaixu. I iêl agarraba-se às piedras mas al outro tinha mas fuarça i queria tira-lu da puonte para baixu. I el agarrou-se unde pude i nun u pude atirar dal puonte. Daquel pontu habia ua canada que martchaba pal riu i iera mui ingrída i arrastrou al hasta al borda dal riu i agarrou ua piedra i escatchou-le a cabeça cua piedra ferronha (cuas gúmas da piedra ferronha) que cortaba curnu ua matchada. I agarrou atirou al pal riu. I nós de que binhimus de benecir al pan, tchegou un guarda tchamau Rodrigues i dou bouces: — "À d'al rei qui matanun un home!" I nós todus pasmaus, quien siria que morreu i quien nu matou. Nun sabiamus ninhum hasta que uns rapaces binun y al tiu Simun tambien biu da sua buraca i al tontu dixu al tiu Simon, Dious negre, se dices algua cousa, matu-te a ti tambien. A al tal Miguel tontu agarrou i martchou-se pas Ratchas hasté a noute, e à noute bienu para cassa. I logo a xusticia (três u quatro homes que iel iera mui baliente) fonum a prendie-lu. Por que iêl iera mui baliente, todus tinham medu d'entrar a cassa, nun seia que los matara. I entrou al tiu Manuel Metu i dixu: — "Miguel, abre-me a puârta". I el abriu-la i metienun-se us homes da xusticia dentru de cassa. — "Miguel, tu matêste al tiu Baltazar i agora bamus-te a prender". I prendenun as mans atrás. Dessioutru dia pela manhana foi pressu i libanun-nu pa cadeia pa Bergancia três u quatro homes de xusticia. I aspois foi tambien al tiu Ganote, qui iera padrinhu i dixu-lhe qui al Carreira de Bila Franca tambien habia feito ua morte i staba nu mesmu quartu diêl i dixu-le "Miguel, nun ti deixes bater dus outrus pressus, que aqui dixu hai un home baliente".

Dali a otcho dias foi al tiu Ganote a bê-lu à cadeia i dixu-le: — "Miguel, intón qui tal?" I iêl dixu-le: — "Padrinhu tratam-me biên, solu que aqui hai un malandru que anda sempre a cabalu en riba de mi, mas iou agarrei pela cabeça cumu quen bira ua campá, que quedou cumu muartu, i nun se tomou a meter comigu i todus me guardam respeitu".

I agarranum al depois impuntanun-nu lá para baixu pra cassa dos tontus i el si puso un pouco mior. I aspois metenun-nu de xardineiro asté que le pareceu que staba bô. Aspois saliu dali para fuora i binu-se aproximandu al Rio d'Onor. I daba-le bergonha a benhir. Asté que fonun as familias a bisca-lu, que staba in Baçal i nun queria benhir por bê da bergonha. — "Miguel, bamus a nossa cassa!". O sobrinho dixu: — "Tiu, andai pa nossa cassa". Cada mês governaba-al un sobrinho i iêlus stimaban-al bien, mas iêl staba ensináu a andar pal mundu, i nun s'acustumaba a star suxeitu a nenhun lugar. I terminou de se martchar embora, a pedir pelu mundu. Que nun queria star aqui. Agora bai cincú u seis anos que martchou i nun si sabi diêl.

3.1 Consonant Features

Feature	Rionorês	Portuguese	Leonese/ Castilian	Examples from text
B/V merger (betacism)	/b/ for both	/b/ vs /v/	/b/ for both	<i>baliente, ber, bira, bergonha, benhir, binhimus, bienu, bê, bou, bás, bades, ban</i>
Africate [tʃ] for Pt. [ʃ]	/tʃ/	/ʃ/	/tʃ/	<i>tchamar, escatchar, matchada, martchar, otcho</i>
Palatal [ʃ] for Pt. [z] / [ʒ]	/ʃ/	/ʒ/ or /z/	/x/ (Sp.)	<i>dixu, dices, xardineiro, xusticia, suxeitu</i>
B/V in intervocalic position	/b/	/v/	/b/	<i>tchamaban, habia, staba, daba, gobernaba</i>
Syncope of intervocalic -d-	∅	/d/	variable	<i>pasmau (pasmado), tchamau (chamado), criaui (criado), ensinai (ensinado)</i>
L- yoticization / disappearance	/j/ or ∅	/ʎ/	/x/ (Sp.)	<i>conseio (conselho), fia (filha), mior (melhor)</i>
S/Z neutralization	merger toward /ʃ/	/s/ vs /z/	/x/ (Sp.)	<i>xardineiro, xusticia, suxeitu</i>
Desnasalization of final -m	∅	nasal	∅	<i>home (homem), bô (bom)</i>

3.2 Vowel Features

Feature	Rionorês	Portuguese	Leonese	Examples
Diphthongization of Lat. Ĕ → ie	/je/	/e/ or /ɛ/	/je/	<i>piedra, pierna, baliente, iera, iêl, iêla</i>
Diphthongization of Lat. Ŏ → uô/uâ	/wo/, /wa/	/o/ or /ɔ/	/we/	<i>puonte, puârta, fuarça, fuôra, muartu, ruôdra</i>
Raising of átono e → i	/i/	/i/	variable	<i>piquenu, mior (melhor)</i>
ão → au / an	/aw/, /an/	/ẽw̃/	/an/	<i>irmau, pan, man, manhana</i>
ãe → ai	/aj/	/ěj/	/aj/	<i>mai (mãe), hai (há), bai (vai)</i>
io → iu	/ju/	/iu/	—	<i>riu, tiu, friu</i>
Nasalization patterns	nasal vowel + oral consonant	nasal diphthong	consonantal nasal	<i>pan /pan/, man /man/, fonun /fonun/</i>

3.3 Stress (Acentuação)

The tonic accent generally maintains its position, with notable exceptions:

- **Stress retraction in 1pl subjunctive:** *nôs sêjamos* (sejamos), *nós fáçamos* (façamos) — analogical.
- **Oxytone shift from Pt. paroxytone:** *riu* (rio), *tiu* (tio) — due to loss of hiatus.
- **2sg preterite palatalization of tonic /a/ → /e/:** *matêste* (mataste), *comprêste* (compraste) — a distinctive Rionorês feature shared with Galician and Ancarese Leonese.

3.4 Reconstructed Phoneme Inventory

Consonants

	Bilabial	Labiodental	Dental/Alveolar	Postalveolar	Palatal	Velar
Plosive	/p/ /b/		/t/ /d/			/k/ /g/
Nasal	/m/		/n/		/ɲ/	
Fricative		/f/	/s/ /z/	/ʃ/ /ʒ/		
Affricate				/tʃ/		
Lateral			/l/		/ʎ/	
Tap/Trill			/ɾ/ /r/			
Approx.	/w/				/j/	

Notes:

- /b/ covers both historical /b/ and /v/. There is no /v/ phoneme.
- /tʃ/ (voiceless postalveolar affricate) is a hallmark Rionorês feature, replacing Pt. /ʃ/ in many words.
- /ʃ/ is used where Portuguese has /ʒ/ or /z/ (the x-series: *dixu*, *xusticia*), reflecting Leonese sibilant merger.

Vowels

	Front	Central	Back
High	/i/		/u/
Mid	/e/ /ɛ/		/o/ /ɔ/
Low		/a/	

Diphthongs (rising): /je/ (*piedra*, *iera*), /wo/ (*puonte*), /wa/ (*puârta*, *fuarça*) **Diphthongs (falling):** /aw/ (*irmau*, *pasmau*), /aj/ (*mai*, *hai*, *bai*), /ju/ (*riu*, *tiu*), /ej/ (*beio*)

4. Morphological & Grammatical Analysis

4.1 Articles

Definite Article

	Singular	Plural
Masculine	al	los
Feminine	a / la	las

The masculine singular *al* is the most distinctively Leonese feature of Rionorês articles (cf. Asturian *el*, Mirandese *l*, Portuguese *o*).

Contractions with prepositions:

Combination	Form	Example
<i>de + al</i>	dal	<i>dal tiu Baltazar</i> (do tio Baltazar)
<i>de + iêl</i>	diêl	<i>nun si sabi diêl</i> (não se sabe dele)
<i>para + al</i>	pal	<i>martchaba pal riu</i> (ia para o rio)
<i>para + a</i>	pa	<i>pa cadeia</i> (para a cadeia)
<i>para + as</i>	pas	<i>martchou-se pas Ratchas</i>

Indefinite Article

	Singular	Plural
Masculine	un	uns
Feminine	ua	uas

Note: The feminine *ua* (with syncope of intervocalic -m-) is attested in Portuguese as early as 1272.

Contractions:

Combination	Form	Example
<i>cun + ua</i>	cua	<i>cua piedra</i> (com uma pedra)
<i>cun + uas</i>	cuas	<i>cuas gumas</i> (com umas arestas)

4.2 Personal Pronouns

Person	Subject	Portuguese equiv.
1sg	ieu / iou	eu
2sg	tu	tu
3sg m.	êl / iêl / êlo / iêlo	ele
3sg f.	iêla	ela
1pl	nós	nós
2pl	bós	vós
3pl m.	iêlos	eles
3pl f.	iêlas	elas

Notes:

- The 1sg has two variants: *ieu* and *iou* (cf. Guadramilês *you*, Leonese *you/yo*, Pt. *eu*).
- The 3sg *iêl* preserves the Leonese form (cf. Asturian *él*, Old Leonese *yel*), with the diphthongized /je/ from Latin *ĬLLE*.
- The extended forms *êlo/iêlo* add a paragogic vowel.

Object/Complement Pronouns

Form	Function	Example
le	indirect 3sg (= Pt. <i>lhe</i>)	<i>batia-le, dixu-le, daba-le</i>
-lu / -nu	direct 3sg masc.	<i>prendie-lu, libanun-nu, impuntanun-nu</i>
-la	direct 3sg fem.	<i>abriu-la</i>
-las	direct 3pl fem.	<i>bê-las, nas comes</i>
-los	direct 3pl masc.	<i>los matara</i>
-me	1sg reflexive/dative	<i>abre-me, tratam-me</i>
-se	3sg/pl reflexive	<i>enfadou-se, cassou-se, martchou-se</i>
mi	prepositional 1sg	<i>en riba de mi</i>

Critical distinction: Rionorês uses **le** (from Latin *ĬLLĬ*) where Portuguese uses *lhe*, a Leonese/Castilian trait.

4.3 Demonstratives & Determiners

Form	Meaning	Example
aquel / aquiêl	that	<i>aquiêl iê al dia</i>
daquel	from that	<i>daquel pontu</i>
dessioutru	the other (next)	<i>dessioutru dia</i>
todus	all (m.pl.)	<i>nós todus pasmaus</i>

4.4 Prepositions

Rionorês	Meaning	Portuguese	Notes
cun	with	com	Leonese form
sin	without	sem	Leonese <i>sin</i> (Sp. <i>sin</i>)
hasta / hasté / asté / asta	until	até	Castilian <i>hasta</i> ; cf. archaic Pt. <i>fasta</i>
pa / pal / pas	to, for	para	Reduced form
por bê de	because of	por causa de	Lit. "by seeing of"
en riba de	on top of	em cima de	Leonese <i>riba</i>
dal	of the (m.)	do	<i>de + al</i>

4.5 Adverbs

Rionorês	Meaning	Portuguese	Origin/Notes
aspois / despois	after, then	depois	Lat. <i>de post</i> ; cf. Sp. <i>pues</i>
inton	then	então	Simplified nasal
tambien / tamien	also	também	Leonese/Castilian
nun	not	não	Leonese negation
solu	only	só	Castilian <i>solo</i>
bien / biên	well	bem	Castilian <i>bien</i>
onte	yesterday	ontem	Loss of final nasal
agora	now	agora	Same as Pt.
aqui	here	aqui	Same as Pt.
mas	more	mais	Castilian <i>más</i>
mui	very	muito	Leonese <i>mui</i> (Sp. <i>muy</i>)

4.6 Conjunctions

Rionorês	Meaning	Portuguese	Notes
i	and	e	Reduced vowel
cumu	like, as	como	Vowel raising
que	that, because	que	Same as Pt.
inquantu	while	enquanto	Adapted
u	or	ou	Simplified

5. Verb Morphology

The verb system is the richest area of Rionorês morphology preserved in the data. Full paradigms are attested for several verbs.

5.1 Conjugation Tables (from Macias's glossary and analysis)

DIR (to go) — Leonese suppletive verb (Pt. *ir*)

Present Indicative:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	bou	vou
2sg	bás	vais
3sg	bai	vai
1pl	bamos	vamos
2pl	bades	ides/vades
3pl	ban	vão

Preterite (Perfeito):

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	fui	fui
2sg	fuste	foste
3sg	foi	foi
1pl	fumos	fomos
2pl	fustes	fostes
3pl	fonum	foram

BER (to see) — Pt. *ver*

Present Indicative:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	beio	vejo
2sg	bês	vês
3sg	bê	vê
1pl	bêmos	vemos
2pl	bêdes	vedes
3pl	bên	vêm/veem

HABER (to have, existential) — Pt. *haver*

Present Indicative:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	hei	hei
2sg	hás	hás
3sg	há / hai	há
1pl	hemos	havemos
2pl	heis	haveis
3pl	han	hão

TENER (to have, possession) — Pt. *ter*

Present Indicative:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	tengo	tenho
2sg	tienes	tens
3sg	tiên	tem
1pl	tenemos	temos
2pl	teneis	tendes
3pl	tiennem	têm

Imperfect Indicative:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
3sg	tenia	tinha

SER (to be) — Imperfect Indicative

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	iera	era
2sg	ieras	eras
3sg	iera	era
1pl	iéramos	éramos
2pl	iérades	éreis
3pl	ieran	eram

MATAR (to kill) — Regular 1st conjugation, model paradigm

Preterite:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	matei	matei
2sg	matêste	mataste
3sg	matou	matou
1pl	matêmos	matámos
2pl	matestes	matastes
3pl	matanun	mataram

Note: The 2sg *matêste* (with /e/ for expected /a/) is a Rionorês palatalization shared with Galician and Ancarese Leonese. The 3pl ending **-anun** is distinctively Rionorês.

DECIR / DIXIR (to say) — Pt. *dizer*

Preterite:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	dixe	disse
2sg	dixiste	disseste
3sg	dixo / dixu	disse
1pl	diximos	dissemos
2pl	dixistes	dissestes
3pl	dixênum	disseram

PODER (to be able) — Preterite

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	pude	pude
2sg	pudiste	pudeste
3sg	pude	pôde
1pl	pudimos	pudemos
2pl	pudistes	pudestes
3pl	pudienom	puderam

PONER (to put) — Pt. *pôr*

Preterite:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
1sg	pus	pus
2sg	pusiste	puseste
3sg	puso	pôs
1pl	posimos	pusemos
2pl	posistes	pusestes
3pl	pusienum	puseram

5.2 General Verb Morphology Patterns

Imperfect 1st conjugation endings:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
3sg	-aba	-ava
3pl	-aban	-avam

Attested: *tchamaban*, *governaba*, *staba*, *daba*, *agarraba*, *deixaba*, *cortaba*

Imperfect 2nd/3rd conjugation endings:

Person	Rionorês	Portuguese
3sg	-ia	-ia
3pl	-iam / -ian	-iam

Attested: *batia*, *tenia*, *queria*

3pl preterite endings — distinctive reduced diphthongs with nasalization:

Verb class	Ending	Examples
1st conj. (-ar)	-anun	<i>matanun</i> , <i>fonum</i>
2nd/3rd conj.	-enun / -ienum	<i>metienun</i> , <i>prendenun</i> , <i>libanun</i> , <i>pusienum</i> , <i>dixênum</i>

Analogical leveling in preterites: The 1sg form controls the paradigm. Where Portuguese has stem alternations (e.g., *disse/disseste*), Rionorês levels the stem: *dixe* → *dixiste* → *dixo* → *diximos*.

2sg preterite palatalization: The tonic /a/ of Portuguese 2sg preterite (-aste) becomes /e/ in Rionorês: *matêste*, *comprêste*. This is characteristic of the Galician-Leonese continuum.

2pl imperfect in -des: Rionorês preserves the archaic 2pl ending **-des**: *iérades* (éreis), *stímabades* (estimáveis), *tínhades* (tínheis). This is an archaism lost in standard Portuguese.

6. Rionorês–English Dictionary with IPA

All entries extracted from the narrative text, Macias's glossary, and the field observations recorded in the study.

#	Rionorês	IPA (reconstructed)	English	Portuguese	POS
1	abajo	/a'baxo/	below, down	abaixo	adv.
2	acabalu, dir acabalu	/aka'balu/	to go on horseback	ir a cavalo	v.phr.
3	agora bai	/a'gora baj/	long ago (lit. "now it goes")	já lá vão	adv.phr.
4	agarrar	/aga'rar/	to grab, seize	agarrar	v.
5	al	/al/	the (m.sg.)	o	art.m.
6	algua	/al'gwa/	some (f.sg.)	alguma	det.
7	alma	/alma/	soul, person	alma	n.f.
8	amanhar	/ama'ɲar/	to prepare, arrange	arranjar	v.
9	arriba	/a'riba/	above, up	acima	adv.
10	aspois	/as'pojs/	after, then	depois	adv.
11	asta / asté	/asta/, /as'te/	until	até	prep.
12	aca	/baka/	cow	vaca	n.f.
13	ades	/bades/	(you pl.) go	ides	v. 2pl pres.
14	bai	/baj/	(he/she) goes	vai	v. 3sg pres.
15	baliente	/ba'ljente/	brave, strong	valente	adj.
16	amos	/bamos/	(we) go	vamos	v. 1pl pres.
17	ban	/ban/	(they) go	vão	v. 3pl pres.
18	bás	/bas/	(you sg.) go	vais	v. 2sg pres.
19	bê	/be/	(he/she) sees	vê	v. 3sg pres.
20	bê (prep. phr.)	/be/	cause; in <i>por bê de</i>	causa	n.
21	beio	/bejo/	(I) see	vejo	v. 1sg pres.

22	benecir	/bene'θir/	to bless	benzer	v.
23	benhir / binhir	/be'ɲir/	to come	vir	v.
24	ber	/ber/	to see	ver	v.
25	bergonha	/ber'goɲa/	shame	vergonha	n.f.
26	biên	/bjẽn/	well	bem	adv.
27	bienu	/'bjenu/	(he) came	veio	v. 3sg pret.
28	binhimus	/bi'ɲimus/	(we) came	viemos	v. 1pl pret.
29	binun	/bi'nun/	(they) came	vieram	v. 3pl pret.
30	bira	/'bira/	(he/she) turns	vira	v. 3sg pres.
31	bisca-lu	/bis'kalu/	to look for him	buscá-lo	v.+pron.
32	biu	/bju/	(he/she) saw	viu	v. 3sg pret.
33	bô	/bo/	good, well	bom	adj.
34	boca abaixu	/'boka a'bajfu/	face down	de bruços	adv.phr.
35	borda	/'borda/	edge, bank	borda	n.f.
36	bou	/bow/	(I) go	vou	v. 1sg pres.
37	bouces	/'bowses/	shouts	vozes	n.f.pl.
38	buraca	/bu'raka/	peephole, small window	postigo	n.f.
39	cabalu	/ka'balu/	horse; <i>a cabalu</i> = on horseback	cavalo	n.m.
40	cadeia	/ka'deja/	prison	cadeia	n.f.
41	campá	/kã'pa/	bell	campainha / sino	n.f.
42	canada	/ka'nada/	path, lane	caminho	n.f.
43	cassa	/'kasa/	house	casa	n.f.
44	cassar	/ka'sar/	to marry	casar	v.
45	comprêste	/kõ'preste/	(you sg.) bought	compraste	v. 2sg pret.

					pret.
46	conseio	/kõ'sejo/	council	conselho	n.m.
47	cortaba	/kor'taba/	(it) cut	cortava	v. 3sg impf.
48	cousa	/'kowza/	thing	coisa	n.f.
49	criau	/kri'aw/	raised; <i>mal criau</i> = rude	criado; mal-criado	adj.
50	cua	/kwa/	with a (f.)	com uma	prep.+art.
51	cuas	/kwas/	with some (f.pl.)	com umas	prep.+art.
52	cumu	/'kumu/	like, as	como	conj.
53	cun	/kun/	with	com	prep.
54	curnu	/'kurnu/	like (lit. "as a")	como um/a	conj.+art.
55	curral	/ku'ral/	cattle pen, stable	curral	n.m.
56	dal	/dal/	of the (m.)	do	prep.+art.
57	daba	/'daba/	(he/she) gave	dava	v. 3sg impf.
58	decir / dixir	/de'θir/	to say	dizer	v.
59	dessioutru	/desjo'wtru/	the next (day)	no outro dia	adj.
60	despois	/des'pojs/	after	depois	adv.
61	diêl	/djel/	of him	dele	prep. +pron.
62	Dious negre	/djows 'negre/	by God! (oath)	por Deus!	interj.
63	dixe	/'dife/	(I/he) said	disse	v. pret.
64	dixo / dixu	/'difo/	(he/she) said	disse	v. 3sg pret.
65	dixes	/'difes/	(you sg.) say	dizes	v. 2sg pres.
66	dou	/dow/	(he/she) gave	deu	v. 3sg pret.
67	êl / iêl	/ɛl/, /jel/	he	ele	pron.
68	êlo / iêlo	/'elo/, /'jelo/	he (extended)	ele	pron.

69	enfadar-se	/ẽfa'darse/	to get angry, fed up	aborrecer-se	v.
70	en riba de	/ẽ 'riba de/	on top of	em cima de	prep.phr.
71	ensinau	/ẽsi'naw/	trained, accustomed	ensinado	adj.
72	escatchar	/eska'tʃar/	to smash, crack open	partir, rachar	v.
73	estimaban / stimaban	/stima'ban/	(they) esteemed, treated well	estimavam	v. 3pl impf.
74	fia	/'fia/	daughter	filha	n.f.
75	fonum / fonun	/fo'nun/	(they) went	foram	v. 3pl pret.
76	fuarça	/'fwarsa/	strength	força	n.f.
77	fumos	/'fumos/	(we) went	fomos	v. 1pl pret.
78	fuôra	/'fwora/	outside	fora	adv./prep.
79	fuste	/'fuste/	(you sg.) went	foste	v. 2sg pret.
80	gaita	/'gajta/	bagpipe	gaita	n.f.
81	gobernaba	/gober'naba/	(he) supported, fed	governava	v. 3sg impf.
82	guma	/'guma/	sharp edge, blade	gume	n.f.
83	habia	/a'bia/	there was	havia	v. 3sg impf.
84	hai	/aj/	there is	há	v. 3sg pres.
85	hasta / hasté	/'asta/, /as'te/	until	até	prep.
86	home	/'ome/	man	homem	n.m.
87	homes	/'omes/	men	homens	n.m.pl.
88	iêla	/'jela/	she	ela	pron.
89	iêlas	/'jelas/	they (f.)	elas	pron.
90	iêlos / iêlus	/'jelos/	they (m.)	eles	pron.
91	iera	/'jera/	(he/she) was	era	v. 3sg impf.
92	ieran	/'jeran/	(they) were	eram	v. 3pl impf.

93	iérades	/ˈjerades/	(you pl.) were	éreis	v. 2pl impf.
94	iéramos	/ˈjeramos/	(we) were	éramos	v. 1pl impf.
95	ieu / iou	/ˈjew/, /ˈjow/	I	eu	pron. 1sg
96	ingrida	/ˈĩgrida/	steep	íngreme	adj.
97	inquantu	/ˈĩkwantu/	while	enquanto	conj.
98	inton	/ˈĩton/	then	então	adv.
99	irmau	/irˈmaw/	brother	irmão	n.m.
100	irmá	/irˈma/	sister	irmã	n.f.
101	las	/las/	the (f.pl.)	as	art.f.pl.
102	libanun	/libaˈnun/	(they) carried	levaram	v. 3pl pret.
103	listu	/ˈlistu/	clever, smart	esperto	adj.
104	los	/los/	the (m.pl.)	os	art.m.pl.
105	lugar	/luˈgar/	village; specifically Rio de Onor	povoação	n.m.
106	lume	/ˈlume/	fire; matches	lume, fósforos	n.m.
107	magra	/ˈmagra/	slice of dried cured ham	fatia de presunto	n.f.
108	mai	/maj/	mother	mãe	n.f.
109	malandru	/maˈlandru/	rogue, scoundrel	malandro	n.m.
110	manhana	/maˈɲana/	morning; tomorrow	manhã	n.f./adv.
111	mans	/mans/	hands	mãos	n.f.pl.
112	man	/man/	hand	mão	n.f.
113	marota	/maˈrota/	bad, wicked (f.)	má	adj.f.
114	martchar(-se)	/marˈtʃar/	to leave, go away	ir(-se) embora	v.
115	mas	/mas/	more; but	mais; mas	adv./conj.
116	matchada	/maˈtʃada/	axe	machada	n.f.
117	matanun	/mataˈnun/	(they) killed	mataram	v. 3pl pret.

118	matêste	/ma'teste/	(you sg.) killed	mataste	v. 2sg pret.
119	mau	/maw/	bad (m.)	mau	adj.
120	medu	/'medu/	fear	medo	n.m.
121	metienun	/metje'nun/	(they) put	meteram	v. 3pl pret.
122	mior	/mjor/	better	melhor	adj./adv.
123	mordomo	/mor'domo/	community leader (elected annually)	mordomo	n.m.
124	muartu	/'mwartu/	dead	morto	adj.
125	mui	/muj/	very	muito	adv.
126	mundu	/'mundu/	world	mun <u>d</u> o	n.m.
127	ninhum	/ni'ɲun/	nobody, none	ninguém, nenhum	pron.
128	nou	/now/	not (variant)	não	adv.
129	noute	/'nowte/	night	noite	n.f.
130	nun	/nun/	not	não	adv.
131	onte	/'onte/	yesterday	ontem	adv.
132	otcho	/'otʃo/	eight	oito	num.
133	Ougén<u>i</u>u	/ow'ʒenju/	Eugene (name)	Eugénio	n.prop.
134	outru	/'owtru/	other (m.)	outro	det.
135	padrinhu	/pa'driɲu/	godfather	padrinho	n.m.
136	pal	/pal/	to/for the (m.)	para o	prep.+art.
137	pan	/pan/	bread	pão	n.m.
138	pasmaus	/pas'maws/	astonished (m.pl.)	pasmados	adj.pl.
139	pelu	/'pelu/	through the	pelo	prep.+art.
140	piedra	/'pjedra/	stone	pedra	n.f.
141	piedra ferronha	/'pjedra fe'rona/	hard white stone (used medicinally)	—	n.f.
142	piernas	/'pjernas/	legs	pernas	n.f.pl.
143	pindon	/pĩ'don/	banner, pennant	pendão	n.m.

143	pinuon	/pi'nuon/	banner, pennant	pendão	n.m.
144	piquenu	/pi'kenu/	small; as child	pequeno	adj.
145	porrada	/po'rada/	blow, punch	pancada	n.f.
146	prendenun	/prêde'nun/	(they) arrested	prenderam	v. 3pl pret.
147	pressu	/'presu/	prisoner; arrested	preso	n.m./adj.
148	puârta	/pwarta/	door	porta	n.f.
149	pude	/pude/	(I/he) could	pude/pôde	v. pret.
150	puonte	/pwonte/	bridge	ponte	n.f.
151	puso	/puso/	(he) put	pôs	v. 3sg pret.
152	rapaça	/ra'pasa/	girl	rapariga	n.f.
153	rapace	/ra'pase/	boy	rapaz	n.m.
154	riba	/riba/	top; <i>en riba</i> = on top	cima	n.f.
155	riu	/rju/	river	rio	n.m.
156	ruôdra	/rwodra/	wheel	roda	n.f.
157	salir	/sa'liɾ/	to leave, exit	sair	v.
158	sin	/sin/	without	sem	prep.
159	solos	/solos/	alone (pl.)	sós	adj.pl.
160	solu	/solu/	only	só	adv.
161	star	/star/	to be (state)	estar	v.
162	staba	/staba/	(he/she) was	estava	v. 3sg impf.
163	stimaban	/sti'maban/	(they) esteemed	estimavam	v. 3pl impf.
164	suxeitu	/su'fejtu/	subject to, bound	sujeito	adj.
165	tambien / tamien	/tam'bjën/	also	também	adv.
166	tchamaban	/tʃa'maban/	(they) called	chamavam	v. 3pl impf.
167	tchamar	/tʃa'mar/	to call	chamar	v.

168	tchamau	/tʃa'maw/	called (past part.)	chamado	adj.
169	tchegou	/tʃe'gow/	(he) arrived	chegou	v. 3sg pret.
170	tenia	/te'nia/	(he/she) had	tinha	v. 3sg impf.
171	tengo	/têgo/	(I) have	tenho	v. 1sg pres.
172	tienes	/tjenes/	(you sg.) have	tens	v. 2sg pres.
173	tiên	/tjẽn/	(he/she) has	tem	v. 3sg pres.
174	tiennem	/tjenem/	(they) have	têm	v. 3pl pres.
175	tiu	/tju/	uncle; sir (form of address)	tio; senhor	n.m.
176	todus	/todus/	all, everyone	todos	pron./det.
177	tontu	/tontu/	crazy, mad	tonto	adj./n.m.
178	ua	/wa/	a, one (f.)	uma	art.f.
179	un	/un/	a, one (m.)	um	art.m.
180	unde	/unde/	where	onde	adv.
181	xardineiro	/ʃardi'nejro/	gardener	jardineiro	n.m.
182	xusticia	/ʃus'tiθja/	justice; police	justiça	n.f.

7. Comparative Table: Rionorês vs. Quadramilês vs. Mirandese vs. Portuguese

Feature	Rionorês	Guadramilês	Mirandese	Portuguese
Masc. def. article	<i>al</i>	<i>o</i> (Pt. influence)	<i>l</i>	<i>o</i>
Fem. def. article	<i>a/la</i>	<i>la / a</i>	<i>la</i>	<i>a</i>
"bread"	<i>pan</i>	<i>pan</i>	<i>pan</i>	<i>pão</i>
"hand"	<i>man</i>	<i>mã</i>	<i>mano</i>	<i>mão</i>
"I"	<i>ieu/iou</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>eu</i>
"he"	<i>iêl</i>	<i>el</i>	<i>el</i>	<i>ele</i>
"not"	<i>nun</i>	<i>nun/num</i>	<i>nun</i>	<i>não</i>
"already"	—	<i>yá</i>	<i>yá</i>	<i>já</i>
"with"	<i>cun</i>	<i>cun</i>	<i>cun</i>	<i>com</i>
"until"	<i>hasta/asté</i>	<i>atá</i>	<i>hasta</i>	<i>até</i>
"stone"	<i>piedra</i>	—	<i>piedra</i>	<i>pedra</i>
"leg"	<i>pierna</i>	—	<i>pierna</i>	<i>perna</i>
"door"	<i>puârta</i>	—	<i>puorta</i>	<i>porta</i>
"bridge"	<i>puonte</i>	—	<i>puonte</i>	<i>ponte</i>
"dead"	<i>muartu</i>	—	<i>muorto</i>	<i>morto</i>
"strength"	<i>fuarça</i>	—	<i>fuorça</i>	<i>força</i>
Betacism (b/v)	✓	✓	✓	✗
Affricate tch- [tʃ]	✓ (<i>tchamar</i>)	✗ (<i>chamar</i>)	✓ (<i>tchamar</i>)	✗
Ě → ie diphth.	✓ (<i>piedra</i>)	✓ (<i>fiesta</i>)	✓	✗
Ů → uô/uâ diphth.	✓ (<i>puonte, puârta</i>)	✓ (<i>almuorço</i>)	✓	✗
Imperfect -aba	✓	✓	✓	✗ (-ava)
3pl in -n/-nun	✓ (<i>matanun</i>)	✓ (<i>stában</i>)	✓	✗ (-m/-ram)
x- for j- [ʝ]	✓ (<i>xusticia</i>)	✗	✓	✗
Official status	✗	✗	✓ (1999)	N/A

8. Syntax Notes

8.1 Word Order

Basic word order is SVO, consistent with Portuguese and Leonese:

- *Al Miguel tontu enfadou-se* — "The crazy Miguel got angry" (SV)
- *El agarrou ua piedra* — "He grabbed a stone" (SVO)

8.2 Definite Article with Proper Nouns and Kinship Terms

The masculine article *al* systematically precedes kinship terms and names used as quasi-titles:

- *al tiu Baltazar, al tiu Manuel Metu, al tiu Ganote, al tiu Simun*
- *al tal Miguel*

8.3 Negation

Simple preverbal negation with **nun** (or variant **nou**):

- *nun staba ua alma* — "there wasn't a soul"
- *nun nu podia ber* — "he couldn't stand him" (lit. "not him could see")
- *nou le deixaba comer* — "he didn't let him eat"

Double negation (negative pronoun + *nun*):

- *nun sabiamus ninhum* — "we didn't know anything at all"

8.4 Clitic Placement

Clitics follow the verb (enclisis) in affirmative sentences, precede it (proclisis) after negation and subordinators — same as Portuguese:

- Enclisis: *batia-le, agarrou-u, escatchou-le*
- Proclisis: *nun nu podia ber; que le tchamaban, nun u pude atirar*

8.5 Use of *tiu* as Honorific

Tiu functions not just as "uncle" but as a general respectful form of address for older men, equivalent to "Mr./Sir" — a feature shared across rural Trás-os-Montes and noted by Macias as replacing *senhor*, which is reserved for strangers.

8.6 Existential *haber*

Rionorês uses **haber** (not *ter*) as the existential verb, like Castilian and unlike modern Portuguese:

- *habia ua canada* — "there was a path"
- *hai un home baliente* — "there is a brave man"
- *nun habia aneles* (Guadramilês) / same construction

8.7 Reported Speech

Direct speech is introduced with the preterite of *decir*:

- *dixu*: "*Rapaces, iou bou hasta cassa...*"
 - *dixe*: "*Miguel, abre-me a puârta*"
-

9. Cultural & Ethnographic Notes from the Text

The narrative "História de um Louco Criminoso" is not just a linguistic document — it is a window into communitarian village life:

- **The Feast of May 3rd (*benecir al pan*):** The communal blessing of bread, a major religious and social event. The entire village goes to mass, leaving the murderer and victim alone.
 - **The *pindon* (*pendão*):** A ceremonial banner or pennant, possibly the church standard that the uncle "prepared" — suggesting he had a liturgical role.
 - **Las magras:** Slices of dried cured ham (*presunto*), the feast-day food. The uncle's cruelty is crystallized in: "*Tu bê-las mas nun nas comes*" — "You can look at them but you can't eat them."
 - **Justice by the community (*xusticia*):** Not state police but local men — "three or four" — who must arrest a man known to be violent. The scene of them too afraid to enter the house echoes the intimate, face-to-face justice of the *conseio*.
 - **The *buraca*:** A peephole or small window — a Leonese term also used in Terra de Miranda.
 - **"À d'al rei!":** The archaic alarm cry "In the name of the king!" — *that someone has been killed!* — a living fossil of medieval Portuguese justice formulas.
 - **The psychiatric institution:** Miguel is eventually sent to a *cassa dos tontus* ("house of the crazy"), put to work as a gardener, and released — a strikingly modern psychiatric trajectory for a rural story. His inability to reintegrate (*staba ensináu a andar pal mundu*) and his departure as a wandering beggar form the story's melancholic coda.
 - **Piedra ferronha:** A specific hard white stone with sharp edges (*gumas*), described as cutting like an axe (*matchada*), and traditionally used to treat snakebites. This is ethnobotanical/ethnomineralogical knowledge embedded in the dialect.
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10. Field Observations (Macias, in situ)

Macias records three spontaneous utterances overheard during visits to the *Melin* shop (the Spanish-side general store where both communities gather):

1. "Tienes lume, Zé?" — "Tiengo." "Do you have a light, Zé?" — "I do." (*tener* conjugation; *lume* = matches/fire)
2. "Onte fumos a Bergancia, ai rapace se tu bisses a burratadeira que tenia o Miguel." "Yesterday we went to Bragança, oh boy if you'd seen the drunkenness Miguel had." (*onte* = yesterday; *fumos* = we went; *Bergancia* = Bragança; *bisses* = you had seen; *burratadeira* = drunkenness; *tenia* = had)
3. "Ougéniu, anda par cassa, abia-te filhu." "Eugénio, come home, hurry up son." (*Ougéniu* = Eugénio; *abia-te* = hurry yourself)

These fragments confirm that the dialect features attested in the written narrative (betacism, *tener* paradigm, *onte*, affricated *tch*-) were still alive in spoken form at the time of the study.

11. Methodological Notes

This analysis is based on:

1. **One narrative text** ("História de um Louco Criminoso") collected by Jorge Dias, transcribed by Herculano de Carvalho, and analyzed by Dina Rodrigues Macias.
2. **The glossary and morphological tables** compiled by Macias from the work of Herculano de Carvalho and Jorge Dias (*O Falar de Rio de Onor*, 1955).
3. **Three spontaneous field utterances** recorded by Macias without the speakers' knowledge.

Limitations:

- The narrative represents a single speaker's idiolect in a specific genre (folk crime narrative).
- Orthographic conventions are inconsistent (e.g., *dixo/dixu*, *aspois/despois*), reflecting transcriber choices rather than phonological certainty.
- The IPA transcriptions are reconstructed from comparative Leonese phonology and the Portuguese-based spelling. Direct acoustic analysis would be needed for verification.
- Code-switching with Portuguese is pervasive and difficult to disentangle from "pure" Rionorês forms.
- The fuller verb paradigms come from Macias's synthesis of earlier scholarly work (Herculano de Carvalho, Jorge Dias), not exclusively from the single text.

Despite these caveats, Rionorês is significantly better documented than Guadramilês, thanks to the pioneering work of Jorge Dias (ethnography) and Herculano de Carvalho (linguistics) in the 1950s, supplemented by Macias's 2003 study.

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Analysis prepared from Dina Rodrigues Macias, "Dialecto Rionorês: Contributo para o seu estudo" (IPB, 2003), incorporating data from Herculano de Carvalho and Jorge Dias. Rionorês has no official orthography, grammar, or dictionary. All IPA transcriptions are reconstructed approximations.